HACK876 × GRACEKENNEDY FOUNDATION

PRIVATE EXPLORATORY BRIEF

An introduction to Hack876 and a conversation about educational fit.

The GraceKennedy Foundation has worked on access to education in Jamaica since 1982. We would like to introduce Hack876 and ask whether there is a suitable way to work together, now or later.

Kingston, Jamaica · Feb 20, 2027 (tentative)



80	9	1
STUDENTS	SCHOOL NETWORK	DAY

One day to build something that should exist.

01 WHAT IS HACK876?

Meet Hack876.



Hack876 is a one-day build competition for approximately **80 secondary-school students** from 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4, roughly 20 teams in all, on Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative).

Teams pick a real problem, use modern tools including AI, get guidance from mentors, and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges. It is not a school assignment and there is no answer key.

Our **9-school network** in Kingston is made up of the schools where the Hack876 team currently has relationships and can coordinate most reliably. It is not an exclusive eligibility list.

BUILD SOMETHING THAT SHOULD EXIST.

Access to quality education is the shared ground.

Hack876 is a free day of learning by building for secondary-school students. Whether that fits the Foundation's work is the question we are asking.

GRACEKENNEDY FOUNDATION, INFORMATION ON GRANTS

"Its mission is to support GraceKennedy's practice and ethos of 'We Care' by creating environmentally sustainable programmes, promoting healthy lifestyles and increasing access to quality education."[1]

The Foundation was established in 1982 to mark the 60th anniversary of GraceKennedy & Company Limited.[3]

Over three decades it has invested some US$1 million in scholarships, at institutions including the University of the West Indies and the University of Technology.[2]

In 2016 it funded an early childhood education STEAM pilot project.[3]

Four decades of investing in education.

1982

Established.

Set up to mark GraceKennedy's 60th anniversary. Its first grants were issued the following year.[3]

1984

A national scholarship.

The Foundation took full responsibility for the GraceKennedy/Jamaica Scholarship.[3]

SCHOLARSHIPS

Some US$1 million over three decades.

Scholarships and bursaries for secondary and tertiary study.[2]

2026 GRANT CALL

Closed, and narrowly focused.

The published call was for early childhood and special needs institutions, with a deadline of April 30, 2026. Hack876 does not fall within it and is not applying to it.[1]



We have read the published criteria. We are asking about fit, not asking for an exception.

9 schools. One room.

Hack876 begins with the schools where we already have relationships and can coordinate most reliably for the inaugural staging. Formal confirmations are still in progress, and the network is not an exclusive eligibility list.

- Hillel Academy
- Campion College
- Jamaica College
- Immaculate Conception High School
- Wolmer's
- Ardenne High School
- American International School of Kingston
- St. Andrew High School for Girls
- St. George's College

Whether there is a route that suits the GraceKennedy Foundation.

The Foundation lists gkfoundation@gkco.com for enquiries about its grants.[1]

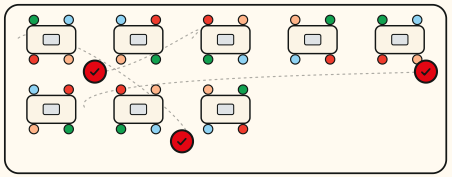
TO EXPLORE

Is there a suitable route, now or later?

- A future grant cycle, if its focus is ever a fit
- A separate route for a school-linked educational activity
- Educational materials students and schools keep using
- Or simply an introduction, with nothing asked

If there is a fit, it does not have to be financial.

PEOPLE IN THE ROOM.



01
A guest at the finals

Someone from the Foundation is welcome to watch the final pitches and meet the students.

02
Advice

Guidance on what would make a project like this a fit for the Foundation, in this year or a later one.

03
An introduction

If another part of the education community is a better home for this, we would be glad to be pointed to it.

GROUND RULES WE WILL HOLD OURSELVES TO

No marketing to students and no sign-ups on the day.

No collection of student contact details by partners. Photos and names only with school and parent consent.

An introduction, and a conversation about fit.

A conversation

NO FUNDING REQUEST IN THIS BRIEF

We would like the Foundation to know Hack876 exists, and to hear honestly whether it could ever fit the Foundation's education work.

This brief is not an application and does not assume Hack876 is eligible for funding. It asks whether a suitable route exists.

WHAT WE WOULD LIKE TO ASK

- ✓ **Is there a future or separate route that could suit an event like this?**
- ✓ **Would a school-linked activity, led with a partner school, be a better fit?**
- ✓ **Are educational materials something the Foundation would consider?**
- ✓ **Who is the right person to speak with, and when?**

08 WHAT WE COULD DISCUSS

Ideas to explore, not a request.

AREAS A CONVERSATION COULD COVER

- **Materials.** Learning materials students and schools can keep using.
- **Equipment.** The equipment teams build with, and what happens to it afterwards.
- **Programming.** Mentoring and the student programme, on the day and after it.

These are ideas to explore. None of them is an agreed activity or a funding request.

WHAT WE UNDERSTAND FROM THE PUBLISHED GUIDELINES

The Foundation's criteria require a registered non-governmental organisation or educational institution. Grants are not made in response to general appeals or for the hosting of conferences. The 2026 call closed on April 30, 2026. We do not assume Hack876 is eligible.

09 A DIRECT LINE

We would rather ask than assume.

This brief is for **the GraceKennedy Foundation team**.[1]

If the GraceKennedy Foundation sees a possible fit, we would welcome guidance on the right route and timing. If not, thank you for reading.

QUESTIONS WE WOULD ANSWER TOGETHER

- ✓ Is Hack876 the kind of work the Foundation could ever support?
- ✓ Would it need to come through a school or a registered organisation?
- ✓ When does the Foundation next review its focus areas?
- ✓ When and where is Hack876?
- ✓ How are students protected on consent, data and marketing?

A conversation, not a workload.

Deliberately focused.

Our vision is national. This inaugural staging does not have national-event resources, and we will not pretend it does.

Approximately 80 students. A school network of 9 in Kingston. One day, done properly.

Build the first one well.
Learn from it.
Earn the right to make the second one bigger.

2027

Start with a conversation.

No funding or commitment is being requested.

FUTURE POSSIBILITIES, ONLY IF BOTH SIDES FIND IT VALUABLE. NOT COMMITMENTS.

- A school-linked activity designed with a partner school.
- Educational materials that stay with schools after the day.
- An application in a future cycle, if the focus fits and Hack876 is eligible.



HACK876 × GRACEKENNEDY FOUNDATION

Somewhere in that room may be a future founder, engineer, designer or leader.

They do not need us to decide who they become.

They need an opportunity to begin.

HELP US BUILD THAT OPPORTUNITY.

We would welcome a conversation with the GraceKennedy Foundation team, whatever the answer turns out to be.

Kingston, Jamaica · Feb 20, 2027 (tentative)

hack876.com info@hack876.com

SOURCES

1. GraceKennedy Group, "GK Foundation: Information on Grants." gracekennedy.com/information-on-grants/

2. GraceKennedy Group, "GK Foundation: Contribution to Education." gracekennedy.com/gk-foundation-contribution-to-education/

3. GraceKennedy Group, "GK Foundation: History." gracekennedy.com/gk-foundation-history/

A private exploratory brief prepared for the team at the GraceKennedy Foundation.